

Between the lines

(Continued from Page 1D)

ager of Memphis and Cohen was managing the New Orleans team.

In a facetious mood prior to a baseball game between UTEP and Ranger Junior College, home plate umpire Scotty Harris said, "If it wasn't for these glasses, I'd still be in the majors."

Harris is a former umpire in the Texas League and Pacific Coast League and was umpiring his first Miner game of the season.

Apparently, Miner Coach Larry McFarlin agreed with Harris. During a disputed call, McFarlin offered the umpire his sunglasses. Instead, McFarlin got the thumb.

Former major leaguer Sid Cohen, giving his preference on what type of pitch to hit: "My favorite pitch was when it was inside. Bobby Feller threw me one chest-high inside and I doubled down the line. The next time up, he threw three balls I didn't even see."

UTEP's wrestlers must have been pleased to host to last week's the state championships, because hosting it meant they would need only to travel as far as their own gymnasium. The story was entirely different last year when Richland College (in a Dallas suburb) hosted it.

One Miner wrestler came away with a separated shoulder, another with a compressed fracture of a vertebra and the rest with plenty of bumps and bruises. All eight wrestlers on the trip wound up in the hospital.

tal.

No, it wasn't their poor wrestling that put them there. Rather the injuries were sustained on the trip back to El Paso when the van driver swerved to avoid hitting a jack rabbit. The van flipped over and landed on the median.

The team was taken to the hospital but was released the next day. The van had been demolished. The wrestlers returned home by charging their bus tickets to the father of one matman's credit card. And the rabbit?

Quote Miguel Rodela, driver of the van: "The rabbit probably just turned around and laughed at us."

The U.S. Olympic hockey team's upset victory over a veteran Soviet squad resulted in an unusual gesture of good will between American and Russian forces in the Indian Ocean area, according to an Associated Press report.

Defense officials said two Soviet IL-38 patrol planes radioed congratulations to a U.S. A-7 fighter which had intercepted them while they were flying near the U.S. carrier Coral Sea.

The Soviet airmen switched their radios to an international frequency and, speaking in English, congratulated the Americans on the Olympic triumph.

Last weekend, after the American hockey team had won 4-3 at Lake Placid, N.Y., the U.S. aircraft carrier Nimitz flashed the news by blinker light to a Russian intelligence-gathering ship steaming nearby.

New Mexico State's basketball team won't be going to Hawaii next

season, but the Aggie coaches have a nice travel lure for prospective recruits: a trip to San Francisco before Christmas.

After playing New Mexico in Albuquerque Dec. 20 next season, the Aggie cagers will play the University of San Francisco Dec. 22 and Santa Clara Dec. 23. "We got a pretty good guarantee from San Francisco," NMSU Athletic Director Keith Colson said of the trip.

The Aggies also have road dates with Texas and Colorado and, in addition to the jousts with traditional rivals UNM and UTEP, will play Baylor at home. Athletes in Action may also return to the Pan American Center.

Ironically, San Francisco will be coming to El Paso Dec. 27-28 for the Sun Bowl College Basketball Tournament.

Dave Peck, now head pro at the Supreme Court Racquetball Club, speaks of his playing about the country in tournaments: "When I tell them I'm from El Paso, their faces kinda go blank . . . you know the feeling. They say, 'Is that part of Dallas or Houston?'"

"Nobody seems to have heard of El Paso, except golfer Lee Trevino once lived here, the Rio Grande stops there, or singer Marty Robbins wrote a song about it. As a pro, I'm just not with the rest of the crowd. They're all from San Diego or St. Louis."

But, now that Peck is the No. 2 player in the world among National Racquetball Clubbers, the handshakes are getting firmer; El Paso is getting on the racquetball map.

To All-WAC football players Eddie Forkerway and Bubba Garcia of UTEP the answers to a pair of questions proved quite displeasing.

Both had been told to register in classes that would not conflict with the football team's training schedule. Part of the training was in UTEP's new weightlifting room.

But there arose a problem. The senior football players followed the coach's advice but found out that at the end of the season they were no longer considered "athletes." Simply put — they could not use the weightlifting facilities during athletes' hours.

The solution? The coaches advised Forkerway and Garcia to use the facilities during student hours — which coincidentally conflict with their new class schedules.

Clones, possibly? Seems that way to Richard Luna, *Times* sports writer, and Richard Luna, UTEP Student Programs Office employee.

Luna at UTEP keeps getting writer Luna's messages. For instance, Austin Coach Leon Antwine called the Luna at UTEP to provide some information for a story, while one of General Omar Bradley's aides called *The Times'* Luna to compliment him on a project, both callers getting the wrong Luna.

UTEP Luna finally caught up with writer Luna the other day and asked, "Do you ever get nasty phone calls in the morning about your stories?"

The Times' Luna answered, "No." "Well, I do."